ETIB

Interpreter Self-Training Platform

Ecole de Traducteurs et d'Interpretes de Beyrouth | USJ Beirut

User Guide

For Students and Instructors

Working languages: Arabic | French | English

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Supervised by Prof. Lina Sader Feghali and Prof. Wadad Wazen Gergy

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1. First-Time Setup

There is nothing to configure. The platform's AI services (Gemini for speech generation and evaluation, Groq Whisper for transcription) run on the server with central keys, so you do not need an API key of your own.

> *Sign in, create an account, or continue as a guest, then go straight to Module A.*

2. Create an Account and Log In

- Open the platform in your browser
- Click Create an account
- Enter your full name, email, and a password (at least 8 characters)
- Select your role: Student, Instructor, or Coordinator
- Click Create account — you are logged in automatically

Next time, use Sign in with your email and password.

3. Module A — Generate a Training Speech

Click Generate speech in the navigation bar.

Basic generation (topic-only)

- Choose the Speech language (AR, FR, or EN — the speaker's language)
- Choose the Target language (the language you will interpret into)
- Type a Topic (e.g. "climate change", "digital health", "water scarcity")
- Choose a Domain and adjust the settings below:

Setting	What it does
Speech length	Short (~150 words), Medium (~250), Long (~350)
Difficulty	Beginner, Intermediate, Advanced, Expert
Discourse structure	Argumentative, Narrative, Descriptive, Mixed
Interpretation mode	Consecutive, Simultaneous, Sight translation
Number density	Controls how many figures and statistics appear
Hesitations	Adds natural fillers (euh, um, ah) to the speech
Pressure mode	Speed pressure, topic shifts, cognitive load

- Click Generate speech

The speech appears below. A note tells you whether it was grounded in a real UN document.

Document-grounded generation

Upload a PDF, Word, or text file as the source. The platform extracts key content using AI (RAG) and builds the speech around it.

- Expand Document grounding
- Click Choose file and upload your document
- Adjust settings, then click Generate from document

> *Click Preview retrieved context to see exactly which passages the AI used before generating.*

UN Library

Click UN Library to search real UN speeches and documents. When you select one, the generated speech will be grounded in actual UN content.

4. Module B — Listen and Study

After generating a speech in Module A, click **Audio & materials** in the navigation bar.

Audio playback

- Choose a **voice accent** (Lebanese Arabic, Gulf Arabic, Parisian French, etc.)
- Adjust the **speech rate** for practice pace
- Click **Generate audio** — the audio player appears
- Listen as you would in a booth

Pedagogical materials

Click **Generate materials** to receive:

Material	Description
Key terms	5 important domain-specific terms from the speech
Thematic summary	A visual tree structure of the main ideas
MCQ	2-3 multiple-choice comprehension questions with answers
Open questions	Discussion questions about the speech content
Trilingual glossary	AR / FR / EN equivalents for the key terms

- Click **Download glossary (DOCX)** to save the glossary as an editable Word file

5. Module C — Record Your Interpretation

- Click **Record & transcribe** in the navigation bar
- Select the language of YOUR interpretation (not the source speech)
- Click the record button and start interpreting
- Click **Stop** when finished
- Click **Transcribe** — takes 5-15 seconds with Groq, up to 2 minutes with the local fallback

The transcript appears with timestamps. For Arabic, the system adds tashkeel (vowel diacritics) reflecting what you actually pronounced, including errors. Low-confidence words are highlighted — these may indicate pronunciation issues.

6. Module D — Get Your Evaluation

Click Evaluation in the navigation bar. This module compares your recorded interpretation against the original speech.

Scores (0 - 100)

Score	What it measures
Overall	Combined performance score
Fluency	Smooth delivery — fewer hesitations = higher score
Coverage	How much of the source content you conveyed
Numbers	Accuracy of numbers, dates, and statistics

Error breakdown

- Hesitations detected (euh, um, ah, ...) — count and positions
- Omissions — content from the source you missed
- Number errors — figures you got wrong or skipped entirely
- Terminology issues — key terms not used in your interpretation

You also receive an AI feedback paragraph. For Arabic, a pronunciation report shows word-by-word confidence scores and likely tashkeel errors.

Adaptive recommendations

After each session the platform analyses your recent history and recommends a difficulty level, speech length, and domain. Go to Module E and click Apply these settings to use them next time.

7. Module E — Track Your Progress

Click Progress in the navigation bar to see:

- Latest session — your most recent scores at a glance
- Score trend — chart of your last 10 sessions
- Focus areas — skills that are declining or stable and need priority
- Strengths — areas where you are consistently performing well
- Specific errors — your most frequent recurring mistakes
- Recommendations — difficulty and domain suggestions from the AI

> *Progress is tracked automatically every time you complete a full evaluation in Module D. You do not need to do anything extra.*

8. Tips for Effective Practice

Module A — Speech generation

- Move to Advanced difficulty once you score consistently above 75 on Intermediate
- Turn on Hesitations to simulate real speaker conditions
- Use Number density: High if you struggle with figures — a common weak point
- Try the UN Library for authentic content on real UN topics

Module B — Study materials

- Study the key terms before listening to reduce cognitive load
- Read the thematic summary to build a mental map of the speech
- Download the glossary and review it the evening before a practice session

Module C — Recording

- For simultaneous: start recording as soon as you hear the first sentence
- For consecutive: take the speech segment by segment if you prefer
- Speak clearly — the ASR model works better with clear articulation

Module D — Evaluation

- Always use full evaluation with audio — it gives the complete picture
- Focus on one score at a time. If fluency is low, prioritise reducing hesitations
- Read the AI feedback paragraph carefully — it identifies patterns across sessions

General

- Practice 20-30 minutes every day rather than once a week for 2 hours
- After each session, check Focus areas in Module E and choose your next topic accordingly

9. Troubleshooting

Speech generation is slow

Normal generation takes 5-15 seconds. If longer than 30 seconds, the AI provider's rate limit may have been reached. Wait 1 minute and try again. If the platform has not been used for 15+ minutes, the first request can take 2-3 minutes while the server wakes up.

Transcription takes 2+ minutes

The hosted transcription service may be temporarily unavailable or rate-limited. The platform falls back to a local model automatically, which is slower. Try again later.

The recording button does not appear

Your browser needs microphone permission. Click the microphone icon in the address bar, allow access, then reload the page.

Scores seem too low

The platform is calibrated for conference interpreter training standards. A score of 60-70 is solid for a first attempt. Focus on consistency across sessions.

"No matching UN document was found"

The UN Library did not find a document matching your topic. The speech is generated without grounding but includes factual accuracy guidelines. Try a more specific topic or a different language.

Quick Reference

Action	Where to find it
Generate a training speech	Module A — Generate speech
Listen to the speech / get audio	Module B — Audio & materials
Download the glossary (DOCX)	Module B > Generate materials > Download glossary
Record your interpretation	Module C — Record & transcribe
Get your score and AI feedback	Module D — Evaluation
See your history and score trend	Module E — Progress
Apply AI-recommended settings	Module E > Apply these settings